Ria

Local context — Bicol, Philippines / Bicol University

How to use this: not a verbatim script — nobody is expected to read from it word-for-word, and realistically no one will stick to a script anyway. Study it well enough to explain each point in your own words, improvise if you're cut off, and answer a follow-up without freezing. If a question lands outside your section, give the short version and hand off by name — every presenter's script and the underlying `FIELD-NOTES.md` are in the same GitHub repo.

Field-visit recap (read this first if you missed a visit)

Everything in the deck traces back to these visits — this is the shared ground truth every presenter should know, whether or not you were there.

Tatay's cacao farm, Batbat (Tuesday, Aug 26). A 2.5-hectare farm run by Tatay alone — his children work in the cities — 100% organic, and he has health problems that limit how much heavy labor he can do himself. His farm used to produce about 500 kg of cacao a year (sold at ₱75–100/kg); this season it's close to **zero**, because of pests and disease. His own estimate of the farm's potential if pests were solved: **2,000 kg/year** — a 4× recovery, the biggest single lever we found anywhere. Cacao flowers year-round here, so the pest pressure never gets an off-season. On water, his framing was specific: the constraint is water *pressure*, not volume — he can't even estimate how many sprinklers his source could feed — and he's open to drip irrigation and rainwater collection. Important attribution point: Tatay described the problems and constraints; the pilot plan, the tools, and every proposed solution came from our own investigations, not from him.

What the farmers and Muravah told us directly. Pest control is their #1 problem — ahead of typhoon, which everyone called "unpredictable" and would rather we not chase. Post-harvest losses run 80–100% from pests/disease across the network, and 60% of pods die from careless handling alone (worse under Mayon ashfall). Farmer income is ₱2,000–10,000/month — below Bicol's ₱13,624/month poverty line for a family of five — the average farmer is about 50, and there's no succession pipeline; Muravah copes by recruiting BU Guinubatan students. Two hard rules for any solution: **organic only** (no synthetic fertilizers or pesticides, ever) and **no AI/robotics** ("not there yet," "AI is biased according to the natives") — low-tech and human-in-the-loop is a values position for them, not a budget issue. More labor doesn't raise profit, because pest pressure caps yield no matter how much work goes in.

Muravah Foundation / Mayon Gold. The cacao NGO anchoring all of this: cacao profits fund typhoon-proof homes and scholarships, heirloom native cacao interplanted with Pili and coconut, and a production-cycle data study already running across 500–1,000 farmers — which is where our pilot would live.

The processing facility. Their own #1 problem is power outages, but the line that matters for us: they're "sometimes out of supply for cacao." Farm-level pest losses upstream directly destabilize the factory downstream — fixing the farms fixes two problems at once.

The other farms (Aug 27–28, now Extras slides). Tatay Aldavis's rice/dairy farm school (a different "Tatay" — it's a Bikol honorific for an elder, not a name) controls pests with herbal sprays and ducks that eat snails — proof organic pest control works in Bicol; plus a bamboo farm, stingless-bee honey producers, the Zambales agrivoltaics site (the ₱10M funding benchmark), and a youth agritourism program.

Your slides

You're the local-context voice — from Bicol, studying at Bicol University. Your slides are the **field-visit slides**, and three of them (7, e1, e2) are deliberately **image-led**: one title, one subtitle, no bullet points. Let the photos carry those — narrate briefly and personally rather than reciting facts. Your Bicol/BU background is a genuine asset here, use it. Note that e1 and e2 now live in the Extras appendix — you only present them if a question or spare time pulls them up, but know them cold anyway.

Slide 2 — Mayon Gold / Muravah Foundation.

Muravah Foundation (branded "Mayon Gold") is a cacao NGO in Albay: cacao profits fund typhoon-proof homes and education scholarships. They grow heirloom native cacao interplanted with Pili and coconut (agroforestry), and are **strictly organic** — no synthetic fertilizers or pesticides, ever. That's a hard constraint on everything proposed later in the deck. They face a labor/succession gap (average farmer age ~50, no government training pipeline) and cope by recruiting students from **BU Guinubatan** — worth mentioning you study at Bicol University too, it's a real, authentic tie-in, not a coincidence to skip past. They're running a production-cycle data study across 500–1,000 farmers already, and they are explicitly skeptical of AI/robotics ("not there yet, other problems to solve," and "AI is biased according to the natives") — that skepticism becomes important later when Keisuke and others present low-tech solutions.

Slide 7 — Tatay's Farm, Batbat (image-led).

We visited Tatay's 2.5-hectare cacao farm in the Batbat area. He's a solo operator (his children work in the cities), 100% organic, and dealing with real health problems that limit how much labor-intensive work he can physically do himself. Keep it to one or two sentences — the numbers come on the next slide (Chow's).

Slide e1 — Rice, Dairy, Bamboo & Honey Farms (image-led, Extras).

We visited **Tatay Aldavis's** rice/dairy farm — a completely different farmer from Tatay in Batbat, same honorific ("Tatay" is a Bikol term for elder/grandpa, not a unique name), worth clarifying if anyone looks confused. His farm is thriving, government-supported, and runs an accredited farm school. They control pests with herbal sprays and ducks grazing on snails, with a chemical fallback only as a last resort. We also visited a bamboo farm (no problems reported except typhoon) and stingless-bee honey producers (honey, bee, and propolis — propolis is the most valuable, used medicinally). Throughline: proof that low-tech, organic pest control already works elsewhere in Bicol.

Slide e2 — Solar, Wind & Agritourism (image-led, Extras).

Covers the Zambales solar farm and its agrivoltaics research (solar co-located with farming — irrigation, cold storage, fish hatcheries), the San Miguel Bay offshore wind project (a ₱170B+ regional renewable-energy investment, mentioned as context; we have no photos of it), the Neonormal Agventure taro project, and a youth agritourism program aimed at getting young people interested in farming again. Say the words "solar panels" explicitly here if e3 is coming next — Masa's chart slide builds directly on this visit.